



Old bones, new technology

Modern technology, like this ground-penetrating radar, can be used to find bones below the rock surface. In the 1980s, a dinosaur named *Seismosaurus* was found in this way, in New Mexico.

Handle with care

Although dinosaurs were strong when they were alive, their fossils are very fragile now. Digging up a dinosaur is a slow and very delicate process.



1. The thick layers of rock above the dinosaur are often cleared away with mechanical diggers, and sometimes blasted away with explosives.



2. The last 8 inches (20 centimeters) or so of rock above the dinosaur are removed very carefully with tools.



3. The exact positions of the bones are then mapped out and recorded with drawings and photographs.



4. The fragile bones must be covered with plaster for protection, before they can be moved away from the site.



5. Finally the strengthened bones are loaded up in a van and driven to a laboratory for further study.

Dinosaur trap

The Dinosaur National Monument in America is one of the world's richest dinosaur treasure troves. It was once a sandy riverbed, which trapped many dying dinosaurs and preserved their bones.



Fossil collection

Dinosaur bones are not the only kind of fossils found at dinosaur sites.



Footprints



Skin



Stomach stones



Eggs



Droppings



Teeth